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Last week: DJIA 52900.07 ▲ 1023.96 1.97% NASDAQ 25832.67 ▲ 2.1% STOXX 600 652.77 ▲ 2.66% 10-YR. TREASURY ▼ 27/32, yield 4.477% OIL \$68.69 ▼ \$0.54 EURO \$1.1436 YEN 161.37

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The Russell 2000**, which tracks shares of smaller companies, climbed some 22% in the first six months of the year, posting its best first half since 1991 and beating the Nasdaq composite by around nine percentage points. **A1**
- ◆ **After five years** on the road, the average EV will still be able to drive up to 95% of its original range—better than many in the auto industry expected. **A1**
- ◆ **A year ago**, the message from many business leaders was that AI was going to wipe out jobs, but the narrative has shifted from worker-light doomsday scenarios to a future in which workers keep their jobs—and get a productivity boost. **B1**
- ◆ **The co-founder** of \$8 billion asset-management firm Bramshill Investments was ousted for not complying with his own in-office policy—and now he is suing. **B1**
- ◆ **The American steel** industry is reaping the benefits of the AI data-center construction boom, but now it is warning of a high-stakes competition with their data-center customers for electricity. **B1**
- ◆ **The slice** of private software debt worth less than 80% of its original value hit a five-year high last year, according to an analysis provided by MSCI. That share peaked at 6.1% at the end of September, or roughly five months before software-company stocks declined ion worries about AI tools. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Controversy erupted** at the World Cup after Trump personally intervened to have U.S. striker Folarin Balogun reinstated for the team's game Monday against Belgium following his red card suspension in the previous round. **A1, A14**
- ◆ **Iran, Russia, North Korea** and other targets of sanctions have dramatically increased their use of virtual currencies to bypass traditional banks and duck U.S. pressure. **A1**
- ◆ **NASA chief** Jared Isaacman flew a vintage jet fighter at the Fourth of July air show over Washington, despite air-safety regulators' objections. **A3**
- ◆ **A growing number** of GOP lawmakers have little incentive to come to work or toe the party line, putting critical legislation in danger as Republicans lurch toward the midterms. **A1**
- ◆ **The U.S. rang** in its 250th birthday in the capital with record-setting heat, thunderstorms, an enormous fireworks display and a speech from Trump emphasizing American exceptionalism. **A3**
- ◆ **Democrats are casting** the president's growing in-office wealth as corruption and a sign he has lost focus on Americans' finances. **A4**
- ◆ **The nation's former** top military officer, CQ Brown, questioned Trump's deployment of troops in U.S. cities and warned against tainting the armed forces' service with politics. **A5**
- ◆ **China released** a prominent Christian pastor, Ezra Jin, from jail after nine months following pressure from the U.S. **A6**

JOURNAL REPORT

Investing Monthly: ESG investing after the 'woke' backlash. **B5-6**

CONTENTS	Market Data..... B8
Arts Review..... A13	Opinion..... A15-17
Business & Finance B2-3	Personal Journal A11-12
Capital Account..... A2	Sports..... A14
Crossword..... A12	Technology..... B4
Heard on Street..... B11	U.S. News..... A2-5
Journal Report..... B5-6	World News..... A6-7



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Throngs Mourn Iran Leader Killed Early in War



DEFIANT: People gathered in Tehran Sunday to pay their respects to late Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who died in February amid Israeli and U.S. airstrikes. The regime is seeking to use the mass gatherings to galvanize supporters. **A7**

Rogue Nations Employ Crypto To Bypass Western Sanctions

By PATRICIA KOWSMANN

Iran, Russia, North Korea and other targets of sanctions have dramatically increased their use of virtual currencies to duck U.S. pressure, handling around \$100 billion of crypto last year alone, firms that track the flows say. They are also becoming more sophisticated in how they navigate the market, creating their own digital tokens and crypto exchanges to help process transactions, the firms and Western authorities say.

Iran and Russia have used virtual cash to buy drones and weapon parts, and Russia has used it to pay salaries for seafarers who smuggle their crude around the world, Western officials and crypto analytics firms say. North Korea, which has mastered the art of

stealing crypto through hacks and other cybercrimes, has used it to buy fuel and military equipment, officials say. Using crypto enables them to bypass traditional banks, which play a central role in policing sanctions imposed by the U.S. and others. "Crypto has changed the sanctions-evasion game significantly," said Kaitlin Martin, a senior intelligence analyst at

analytics firm Chainalysis. It estimates that cryptocurrency addresses linked to entities under sanctions received over \$100 billion in 2025, almost eight times the amount received in 2024. Russia considers international sanctions to be illegal under international law and has "deployed and developed alternative mechanisms that

Please turn to page A7

'Zombie Congress' Imperils GOP Plans

By OLIVIA BEAVERS

WASHINGTON—A growing number of GOP lawmakers have little incentive to come to work or toe the party line, putting critical legislation in danger as Republicans lurch toward the midterms. Some are privately calling it the zombie Congress. GOP leaders are increasingly concerned that members will lose motivation to show up, or may break with the party if they do, potentially stalling or killing some bills, according to lawmakers and aides. While the Senate has been the main focus of GOP cracks, the House is also facing an uncertain summer and fall, with attendance issues and a renewed sense of independence among retiring, defeated or angry members threatening to upend the Republican agenda.

"If you're not at least a little bit frustrated right now, then I question your, maybe your sanity. Nobody signed up for this," said Rep. Steve Womack (R., Ark.), who worried problems passing bills could hurt GOP chances in the fall. "Right now it's almost like shooting ourselves in the foot," he said.

Just last week, a renewed rebellion over the stalled Save America Act voter-ID bill stopped action on the House floor and prompted Speaker Mike Johnson (R., La.) to throw in the towel and send members home early for the Fourth of July holiday. On a typically party-line procedural vote meant to set the agenda for the week, holdouts led by Rep. Anna Paulina Luna (R., Fla.) swelled to more than a dozen

◆ **Democrats seize on Trump's rising wealth.... A4**

'No Going Back': The Inside Story Of Europe's Rupture With America

Trump's tariffs and threats against Greenland spurred a rebellion

It was almost midnight in Brussels and the leaders of Europe were locked in their fifth hour of an emergency meeting with a single theme for discussion: how to manage a breakup with America.

By Joe Parkinson, Drew Hinshaw and Daniel Michaels

The new year was only three weeks old and President Trump, after removing Venezuela's autocratic strongman,

had briefly threatened to seize Greenland from Denmark. Around a circular table in the European Council headquarters known as "The Space Egg," heads of government were venting so emotionally about the 47th president that some would later call the session "therapy night."

"We are drawing a line here," began Emmanuel Macron, president of France, according to several leaders present and their most senior aides. For a year, America's closest allies had

tried to placate Trump with a mix of flattery and concessions, hoping to buy time. Now, French soldiers were in Greenland, alongside Danish special forces equipped for a shooting war with America. The French president repeated an argument he'd been pressing for years: that Europe's overreliance on America was a security risk. "There is

Please turn to page A10

◆ **NATO seeks arms buildup..... A6**
◆ **Erdogan cements bigger role..... A6**

Small Stocks Logging Best Run in Decades

By HANNAH ERIN LANG AND SHRADHA DINESH

Small companies are punching above their weight on Wall Street.

The Russell 2000, which tracks shares of smaller companies, climbed some 22% in the first six months of the year. That is the best first half

since 1991, beating the Nasdaq composite by around nine percentage points—its largest outperformance in that period since 2006. At one point last week, the index notched four straight record closes.

It is an often-overlooked bright spot in a market that has for years been dominated

Please turn to page A2

What World Cup? Italians Are Having the Worst Summer Ever

While the rest of the world revels, Italy does its best to ignore the tournament

ROME—The World Cup is in full swing and people the world over are having a ball.

But in Rome, it's easy to forget there is a tournament. Few bars are showing it and only tourists are watching.

"Sometimes, I feel a flicker of curiosity and I wonder what's going on at the World Cup," said Saverio Massi Benedetti, a fund manager and avid

fan of AS Roma, the biggest team in the Italian capital.

"So I google 'World Cup 2026,' but as soon as the page

Please turn to page A12

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
How to build a better retirement-spending plan than the 4% rule. **A11**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
The quest to make humanoid robots safe enough to work alongside humans. **B1**

Battery Durability Energizes EV Drivers

By ELLIE DAVIS

Richard Symons recently took his five-year-old Tesla Model 3 on a 260-mile road trip across England without having to stop for a charge.

A new electric vehicle could make the trip no-problem. But Symons's car—which he has affectionately nicknamed "Miles"—has logged 247,000 miles and is still up for frequent long-distance drives.

Symons, the owner of a U.K.-based used-car sales company that specializes in EVs, has found that the batteries that power these cars continue to perform well even after several hundred thousand miles. This has come as a welcome surprise to him and other EV enthusiasts.

"They are proving themselves to be exceptionally reliable," Symons said. After five years on the road, the average EV will still

Please turn to page A4